MATHÍAS FONDO

Department of Economics, *University of Bologna*
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EDUCATION

PhD Candidate in Economics, *University of Bologna* (Italy) — Nov 2023 – present
Advisors: Giulio Zanella and Denni Tommasi
Expected thesis submission: August 2027 · Expected defense: December 2027

Visiting Student Researcher, *University of California, Berkeley* (USA) — Spring 2027 (scheduled)
Host: Emmanuel Saez

MSc in Economics, *Universidad de la República* (Uruguay) — Feb 2020 – Nov 2022
Grade: 10.7/12 (Ranked #1 in cohort)

BS in Economics, *Universidad de la República* (Uruguay) — Mar 2015 – Jul 2019
Grade: 9.4/12 (Top 5% of cohort)

FORMER POSITIONS

Research Assistant, Department of Economics, *Universidad de la República* (Uruguay) — May 2021 – Oct 2023

Consultant, Department of Economics, *CPA Ferrere* — Aug 2017 – Feb 2020

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor Economics, Public Economics, Applied Microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Equal College, Unequal Payoffs: Student Employment, Major Choice, and the Persistence of Inequality
I study how upward mobility through higher education is constrained by mechanisms that operate after enrollment, in a setting where a single tuition-free, open-access public university accounts for 85% of enrollment in Uruguay. Linking the universe of student records with administrative labor histories, I show that early employment during college and sorting into lower-paying majors, together with dropout and delay, explain nearly two-thirds of the intergenerational elasticity of earnings. A dynamic structural model of sequential college and labor supply decisions shows that pre-college ability gaps are the primary bottleneck, while financial constraints emerge as a binding secondary barrier.

WORKING PAPERS

Bergolo, M. L., Ceni, R., **Fondo, M.**, & Vergara, D. (2025). Minimum Wages and the Distribution of Firm Wage Premia. *NBER Working Paper No. 34188.*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Asymmetric Responses to Labor Income Taxation (with Marcelo Bergolo)

Grades, Academic Performance, and Labor Market Outcomes (with Rodrigo Nicolau and Joaquín Paleo)

Information about Relative Performance and Future Academic Achievement (with Rodrigo Nicolau and Joaquín Paleo)

SEMINARS, CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

2026 Workshop on Minimum Wages and Collective Bargaining (Mannheim, Germany), NSE 5th PhD and Post-Docs Workshop (Naples, Italy), fRDB Conference (Bologna, Italy)

2025 AIEL – DSE Workshop (Bologna, Italy), ECINEQ PhD Workshop (Washington, USA, online)
2024 LAGV Public Economics Conference (Marseille, France), 11th Annual Mannheim Tax Conference (Mannheim, Germany), Work in Progress Seminar (Bologna, Italy)
2023 SLLS Annual Conference (Munich, Germany)
2022 LACEA/IADB/World Bank Network on Inequality and Poverty – Annual Conference (Montevideo, Uruguay)

TEACHING

Econometrics Feb 2025 – present
Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate level, *University of Bologna*

Introduction to Machine Learning for Economists Oct 2024 – present
Teaching Assistant, Master level, *University of Bologna*

Data Mining and Machine Learning Feb 2025 – Apr 2025
Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate level, *Johns Hopkins University – SAIS Europe*

Industrial Organization Mar 2022 – Aug 2022
Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate level, *Universidad de la República*

HONORS AND AWARDS

PhD Scholarship (EUR 71,400) Nov 2023 – Oct 2027
Four-year doctoral scholarship, *University of Bologna*

Honorable Mention for Best Master's Thesis in Economics Dec 2022
Among the top three master's theses in economics in Uruguay, *Uruguayan Society of Economists*

Award for the Best Contribution of Young Researchers (USD 500) Oct 2022
LACEA/IADB/World Bank Network on Inequality and Poverty – Annual Conference

Graduate Academic Commission Scholarship (approx. USD 9,000) Mar 2021 – Dec 2021
Merit-based scholarship of *Universidad de la República* for Master's thesis

Scholarship Program for Student Mobility (approx. USD 11,000) Mar 2020 – Feb 2021
Merit-based scholarship of the Department of Economics for the Master in Economics

PRE-DOCTORAL RESEARCH

Transmisión intergeneracional de normas de género y participación de la mujer en el mercado de trabajo [Intergenerational Transmission of Gender Norms and Women's Labor Force Participation] (with Cecilia Parada and Martina Querejeta)
Investigaciones basadas en la Encuesta de Generaciones y Género. Uruguay 2022. Programa de Población (Udelar) / Banco Interamericano de Desarrollo. 2024

Evolución de las principales variables del mercado laboral uruguayo (2016–2022) [Trends in the Main Indicators of the Uruguayan Labor Market, 2016–2022] (with Paula Carrasco and Cecilia Parada)
Documentos de Trabajo (working papers) 23-17, Instituto de Economía – IECON. 2023

REFEREEING

Journal of Regulatory Economics

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), Italian (advanced) · **Software:** Stata, Python, Julia, LaTeX

REFERENCES

Giulio Zanella, *University of Bologna*
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Denni Tommasi, *University of Bologna*
denni.tommasi@unibo.it